



Ilorin Innovation Hub – Monthly Report

Submitted to: IHS Nigeria

Reporting Period: July 2025

Submitted by: Managing Director

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1. Executive Summary

In July 2025, the Ilorin Innovation Hub recorded significant strides across programs, events, and operations. The Hub hosted and supported 11 key initiatives, spanning government reforms, youth mentorship, digital inclusion, educational empowerment, and emerging tech engagement. Highlights include the STEM Africa Fest series, the Senator Sodiq Umar Mentorship Program, and community-focused sessions like Tech for Market Women and the SUI Blockchain Meetup.

Operationally, the Hub maintained stable financial management, realizing ₦2.47 million in cost savings against the July budget. Internal processes were strengthened through the activation of bank mandates, improvements in compliance and payroll oversight, and the onboarding of health and pension benefits for staff. A structured staff training was also conducted to reinforce the Hub's mission and values, while IT systems continued transitioning into more robust platforms such as Zoho and MTN Fiber.

Facility improvements advanced with elevator installation, scaffold procurement, and responsive maintenance to roof and plumbing issues. Across the board, the Hub continues to evolve as a professionally run innovation space equipped to support growing demand from partners, startups, educators, and the general public.



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2. Programs & Events Report

Programs – July 2025

- **Ministry of Finance – Ease of Doing Business Initiative (in collaboration with Ministry of Justice) – June 30th to July 7th**
A week-long government-led workshop hosted at the Ilorin Innovation Hub by the Kwara State Ease of Doing Business Council (EODBC), bringing together stakeholders to roll out reforms such as digitized land titles, automated permits, MSME data systems, Small Claims Courts, and improved tax processes — all aimed at decentralizing reforms and boosting local economic activity.
- **UNDP-NJFP Stakeholder Engagement Meeting – July 9th**
A gathering under the Nigeria Jubilee Fellows Programme hosted by UNDP on planning their upcoming cohort which is in partnership with IIH.
- **TA Community- Tech For Market Women – July 16th**
A pilot project launched by TA Community (backed by Mastercard Foundation) to empower market women through digital literacy training, vocational support, and financial inclusion tools. The Ilorin Innovation Hub served as its launch platform, with plans to expand to other areas based on the success of this phase
- **Pristine Foundation – Empowering Kwara Teachers to Support Learners with Hidden Learning Disabilities. – July 17th**
A specialized training organized by the Pristine Foundation (in collaboration with STEAM Up Kwara and the Kwara State Government) to equip over 100 educators with inclusive strategies to identify and support students with hidden learning disabilities (e.g., dyslexia, autism)
- **Ilorin DevBox Design Like a Pro: UI/UX Fundamentals with Figma Parts I & II - July 18th & 19th**
These events were under par as there was miscommunication as to the mode of attendance – physical or virtual. The IIH Team had setup the physical workshop locations but nobody showed up.
- **Senator Sodiq Umar 3SU Mentorship Program – July 20th, 21st, 22nd, & 24th** A leadership initiative launched by Senator Sadiq Suleiman Umar, providing selected Kwara youths with 3–6 months of mentorship, access to technology (including laptops), and opportunities for personal and professional growth. The program's inaugural cohort involved about 100 participants, and was personally supported by Governor AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq, who lauded the initiative and engaged directly with the fellows
- **StemFest Teachers Training – July 24th**
A dedicated training workshop for educators centered on the theme “AI for Good:



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Solving Real-World Challenges.” The program aimed to equip teachers with cutting-edge STEM and AI curriculum ideas, tools, and best practices to enhance classroom learning and inspire innovation

- **STEM Africa Fest Kids Program – July 26th**
A children’s STEM festival held at Ilorin Innovation Hub. As part of Africa’s largest kids’ STEM celebration, it engaged young learners through interactive, hands-on STEAM activities and immersive experiences
- **IIH Staff Training – July 28th**
A focused internal development session designed to realign the Ilorin Innovation Hub (IIH) team with the organization’s core values and foster an entrepreneurial mindset among staff. The training emphasized professional growth and team cohesion.
- **SUI Nigeria Blockchain Meetup – July 31st**
A dynamic community gathering under the SUI Nigeria Blockchain network umbrella, held at IIH. This meetup offered attendees insights into blockchain innovations—such as BTC yield strategies, DeFi tools, and financial autonomy—while bringing together tech enthusiasts, developers, and ecosystem stakeholders.
- **Innovation Challenge & Hackathon Roadshow** - This was a multi-stop activation across Unilorin, MALHub, LAUTECH, Ennovate Labs, UniAbuja, FUTMinna, AKUM, Paritie Innovation Hub, FUTA, The Hive Incubator, and The Founder's Hub.



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3. Operations Report

3.1 Finances

- Zenith & Sterling bank accounts have received inflow for some facility rentals.
- Mandate on all accounts fully activated
 - Finance Associate is transaction initiator
 - Managing Director & Director of Programs are signatories/approvers
 - Transactions over N500,000 require joint approval
 - Transactions under N500,000 can be approved by either of the two signatories
- We hit compliance issue with Sterling bank with regards to government ownership of existing structure (which we did not have with any other bank) hence not allowing us to access funds in that account. This is being resolved at State Ministry of Finance.
- We plan to pay staff travel per diem from Sterling account (internally generated revenue)
- We are considering UBA and Fidelity for additional accounts.
- Before our Sterling Bank issue we were able to pay our pledge prize of N500,000 on behalf of the The Kwara State Governor HE Abdulrahman Abdulrazaq to Niniola, the 14-year old content creator who was discovered at the Kwara Kre8 event the previous month.
- Completion of Financial Reports for March to July 2025.

Expenditure

Bank charges	31,853.73
HVAC Maintenance (gas refill)	370,000.00
Cleaning Service	740,000.00
Facility Maintenance and Repairs	2,174,000.00
HMO	2,174,811.00
Guest Entertainment and Refreshments	2,189,476.00
Internet B subscription (Starlink)	57,000.00
Local Travel	1,367,958.00
Miscellaneous Expenses - 2% of Operating Expenses	509,790.00
Salaries and Wages	10,105,872.41
Security	950,000.00
Souvenirs	2,250,000.00
Merchandise and Staff T Shirts	138,000.00

Stationery and Office Supplies	173,414.00
Training and Mentorship	500,000.00
Total — Expenses (B)	23,732,175.14
July Budgeted Expenses	26,203,794
Cost Savings	2,471,618.86

Income

Facility Rentals	2,723,750.00
Guest Entertainment and Refreshments*	2,699,450.00
Total — Income (A)	5,423,200.00

*This is revenue not profit, as some part of expenses were borne from operations account.

3.2 Administration

Front Desk & Office Support

- Oversight of Front Desk Support Staff including one corper. Proper orientation of guest welcoming and direction to relevant part of facility.
- Receipt of correspondence and conversion into digital format supporting our drive towards sustainability and paperless operations.
- Purchase of stationery and office supplies for entire office

Vendor Management

- Initial discussions with Geniserve on new mode of engagement – proper new terms of engagement with IIH as extension of initial engagement by IHS. They got back in touch saying they did not have the capacity to handle our project anymore at the time.
- Engagement of Landscape Vendor who has conducted replanting of some dead plants and grass, mowing of lawn and painting of circular plant areas in front/side.
- Engagement of AC Repair vendor (recommended by Samsung) for urgent repair work

Hospitality

- Hosting of important guests – IHS in prep for STEM Africa Fest, and other Kwara State dignitaries & stakeholders
- Procurement of hospitality items and supplies for VIP lounge
- Engagement and management of food vendors for events
- Coordination of event refreshments

Supporting VIP & MD Guests

- Coordinating general enquiries at front desk and hosting of guests
- Coordination of MD event invitations and appointment scheduling

Facility Rentals

- Coordination of inquiries for facility bookings (Halls, workspaces, meeting room and private offices) and processing of invoicing along with Finance, receipt of payment and refund of security deposits.
- Event planning & coordination with Facility Manager

3.3 Human Resources (HR)

Hiring & Staffing

- Completion of Staff Training Exercise emphasizing team cohesion and
 - Session 1: Rooted in Mission, Powered by Innovation
 - Session 2: Staff Handbook Essentials
- Coordination of interns & corporates across various units – IT Support, Facility Management & Front Desk

Termination of Probationary Employment

- The Finance Associate had started out on a shaky note after launching an all-out smoothie business marketing campaign within the office, which she was warned to stop. She was very error-prone and had been given several opportunities to correct her mistakes but it became clearer that she was not properly qualified for the job. It seemed she was qualified on paper and was able to scale the interview process, but didn't actually have enough accounting knowledge and experience to handle the job. She had been supported regularly in her duties by the IT Manager and IT

Support Associate with financial knowledge/experience. Some of the errors she had made which were caught were:

- Incorrect calculation of prorated salaries in staff payroll
 - Incorrect calculation of deductions, tax and benefits in staff payroll
 - Incorrect reporting (N7m+ discrepancy) which led to delays in submission of financial reports
 - Sending already processed duplicate transaction to bank for processing (N1m difference). This was caught by the bank account officer.
 - Creating an invoice instead of purchase order for food vendor (not really knowing the difference)
 - Getting help over the phone in the carrying out of her duties and disclosing our sensitive information to external parties, thereby breaking the NDA she signed.
 - Inability to operate Zoho Books financial software, even though she mentioned during interview that she had experience with financial software.
 - Last but not least, transmitting entire staff payroll instruction for month of July to bank via Whatsapp on Friday July 25, claiming her instruction email to the bank did not send, and she did not attempt to resend the email at all until the morning of Monday July 28, causing a potentially huge audit infraction. Not only did she not attempt to resend the email throughout Friday and the weekend, she was very visible and active at the Hub on Saturday July 26 attending the STEM Africa Kids Fest. We had to tidy the error by obtaining the printed and stamped copy sent to bank on Friday and including in our records.
- As at the second or third major error made, the Finance Associate was invited by the MD to ask what the problem was and if everything was fine with her because he believed she could do much better. She promised she will do better, but this didn't happen.
 - After a few more mistakes, she approached the MD mentioning that she was scared she might lose her job and might not get confirmed at the end of the 3-month probationary period. The MD told her to be calm and just pay more attention to her work. This was a few days before she made the error with regards to the salary instruction being sent to the bank late after an entire weekend. That was the day her employment was terminated.

Staff Handbook Circulation

- The staff handbook was completed and circulated to all staff, with all staff having signed and returned it, and only one member of staff refusing to sign.



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Compliance

- Registration with regulatory bodies completed: NHF.
- Remittances done for ITF, NSITF
- KW-IRS nominal roll complete with tax funds fully intact, awaiting final NHF activation to confirm final figures and carry out remittance.
- All compliance remittances being recalculated due to some discrepancies found in work done by former Finance Associate. These will be ironed out before end of August.

Welfare & Benefits

- Signup with HMO (Leadway Health) completed
- Pension plan onboarding completed awaiting remittance
- Group Life onboarding ongoing

3.4 Facility Management & Infrastructure

Facility

- On-going Landscaping of the Hub
- On-going Professional Cleaning
- Maintenance of plumbing leaks and damage in toilets
- Renewal of facility DSTV subscriptions
- Management of Solar System and usage of power within the facility during work hours, events and dull/rainy periods with low sunlight.
- Commencement of Elevator Installation. We had to jump into action when the elevator installers resumed to site and mentioned the solar system would not be able to power the elevator. This led to us renting a 20kva generator for one week, and needed to extend to another week due to errors in the elevator install that were not fixed on time (like doors not opening automatically etc). The vendor claimed the elevator is a new model they aren't used to. We also had to buy 40ft of armored cable to connect the generator outside to the elevator. These actions we took were to speed up the process as if we decided to wait for MC&T and the KWSG MBIT to process the installation costs and process it would take a much longer time to complete. The total cost incurred for the elevator installation will be sent separately.

- Purchase of 15ft in-house scaffold for AC and roof repairs. This was necessary to avoid the need to be at the mercy of MC&T every time we need to do maintenance or AC work.
- Geniserve representative Ope returned to site after over a month of being away. He introduced a very big, ugly and old-looking tagging system for the ACs that we have requested to be removed.
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Security

- No major security incident throughout the month of July

Incidents

- **On-going back and forth with MC&T over roof leakage. Roof leaks are still not completely resolved and seem to be increasing in number. We have called MC&T directly for urgent solution even if it requires new roofing sheets in leaking locations.**
- Minor flooding still occurring due to roof leakage across facility, which have all been identified and reported to building contractor MC&T

3.5 IT Support

General IT Support

- On-going installation of MTN fiber internet, awaiting deployment by July 29
- Migration of ad-hoc processes and temporary records to Zoho software on-going
- MTN SIM CUG activation pending due to MTN network issues.
- Setup of our IHS-donated computers in the workspaces upstairs for physical trainings and workshops.

Event Support

- Successful support of all events including audio visual and sound and occasional live streaming

- Support with projectors in workshop style events.

Content & Social Media

- Design of all event banners and promo material
- Design of internal documents and correspondence
- Capturing of event photos and posting to all social media platforms – Instagram, Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn and most recently Tik Tok.
- Development of content strategy for the hub, including individual approach for each platform
- Ongoing development of Community Newsletter on Zoho platform

3.6 Managing Directors Office

- Supervision of two main arms of organization – Programs & Operations while playing role of Director of Operations
- Engagement of stakeholders within & outside Kwara State
- Meeting with US Embassy delegation in Abuja on American Space setup
- Innovation Workshop at IHS Towers in Lagos with Future Africa 29th - 31st July 2025
- Attending Techcircle Pitch2Win5 startup pitch competition at Eko Hotel in Lagos along with Iyin Aboyemi and several other ecosystem contacts. This models what we have planned for our Pitchathon and Techcircle would be a recommended partner as they already have investors lined up who have contributed to their competition over the years.
- Supervising responses to daily inquiries and messages via email and social media platforms usually requesting for partnership, job placement, internship, inquiries about space usage.
- Receiving important visitors and taking them on tour of the hub when available
- Completion & distribution of Staff Core Values ahead of Staff Training
- Regular checkups with Heads of Units on work progress and outstanding tasks

4. Conclusion

The month of July reinforced Ilorin Innovation Hub's role as a critical node for digital innovation, creative engagement, and ecosystem development in Kwara State. Despite challenges—including facility-related delays, improving partner program coordination and



a key staffing transition—the team delivered high-impact programs, deepened partnerships, and improved internal systems.

The diversity of activities—from grassroots market empowerment to high-level government workshops and blockchain meetups—highlights the Hub’s growing capacity to support innovation across sectors. With continued support from IHS and other stakeholders, IIH remains positioned to drive sustainable outcomes and empower the next generation of African problem solvers.